ATHARVA POTNIS

Senior Product Designer | AI / GenAI | SaaS | Healthcare & Fintech

Bangalore • Hyderabad • Pune | +91 89568 64168 | azxthap39@gmail.com | Portfolio • Reel • LinkedIn

PROFILE

Senior Product Designer with 5+ years working across US-based AI / GenAI SaaS, healthcare, and fintech startups. Now relocating to India full-time. I work mostly on 0-to-1 product design, design systems, and figuring out how to make complex LLM, RAG, and ML workflows feel obvious to the people using them. Strong on user research, usability testing, interaction design, IA, prototyping, and data viz. Master's in UX Design from UT Austin (4.0 GPA). Available within 30 days; happy in-office, hybrid, or remote across Bangalore, Hyderabad, and Pune.

Open to: Senior Product Designer, Lead Product Designer, Founding Designer, Staff Product Designer, and Senior UX Designer roles at AI-first SaaS, fintech, healthcare, and enterprise product companies.

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin *Austin, TX, USA*
Master's in Information Studies, Specialisation in User Experience Design | *GPA: 4.0 / 4.0*

Vishwakarma Institute of Technology (VIT) *Pune, India*
Bachelor of Engineering | *GPA: 8.8 / 10*

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founding Product Designer | Zams (prev. Obviously AI) *Oct 2024 – Apr 2026*
San Francisco, USA (Remote). YC-backed AI / GenAI analytics SaaS platform. First and only designer; reported to the founding team and owned product, marketing, and brand surfaces.

- **Sole designer** on an LLM-driven B2B SaaS analytics platform. Owned everything from research and wireframes through high-fidelity prototyping and ship. Reworked the core IA and main interaction patterns, which lifted weekly active engagement by 25%.
- **Built the Figma design system** from scratch: 200+ components, design tokens, typography scales, and usage docs. Average design-to-dev handoff dropped from about 3 days to 1.5 days per feature, and visual consistency across the product stopped being a problem.
- **Shipped 10+ GenAI features 0-to-1**, including a natural-language query builder, an AI insights dashboard, and an automated report generator. Worked closely with founders, engineering, and the data science team on weekly sprints.
- **Defined how AI outputs look in the product** (model explanations, confidence states, hallucination patterns) using typography, layout, and data viz to make the output legible to non-technical analysts.
- **Made wireframes, journey maps, and high-fidelity prototypes** for data-heavy AI flows. Iteration cycles got about 30% faster as a result of tighter usability testing and quicker engineering feedback.

Product Design Consultant (US Startups, Remote) *Sep 2022 – Oct 2024*
Sequential full-time engagements with US-based seed and Series-A startups across healthcare AI, fintech, and non-profit sectors. Several roles concluded due to funding cycles and pivots typical of the post-pandemic US startup market.

Senior Product Designer | Carolina's Psychiatric Institute (Healthcare AI SaaS) | Jan 2024 – Oct 2024

- **Designed an AI-powered clinician platform** covering scheduling, e-prescriptions, and care coordination across 15+ psychiatric practices. Focus was on giving providers faster access to patient data without adding cognitive load.
- **Lifted user satisfaction 20%** through usability testing, A/B experiments, and design refinements over multiple release cycles.
- **Built high-fidelity prototypes** grounded in user research, which sped up design delivery by about 15% and cut down rework during engineering handoff.
- **Pushed for WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility** across sprints. Worked closely with the CMO, Head of Engineering, and clinical staff to get HIPAA-compliant, accessible releases out the door.

Senior UX Designer | Surplus (Fintech / E-commerce) | Sep 2023 – Jan 2024

- **Led mobile and web UX design** on a fintech / e-commerce product. Reworked onboarding and core flows, which contributed to about 20% growth in user engagement.
- **Built scalable layout systems and component standards** across web and mobile in close partnership with front-end engineering.
- **Informed product strategy** using usability testing, A/B experiments, and behavioural analytics to figure out which UX changes were worth shipping first.

UX Designer | WiTT (Donation Platform, Mobile + Web) | Sep 2022 – Sep 2023

- **Redesigned onboarding and core flows** using design thinking and journey mapping. First-time task completion went from 62% to 84%, and drop-off fell by 35%.
- **Reworked the donation journey** through iterative prototyping and usability testing. 74% of users now finish the flow within 5 minutes (+28% conversion).
- **Ran 30+ qualitative interviews and 200+ user surveys** across multiple cohorts. Insights drove 8 shipped product changes and lifted satisfaction scores by 22%.

Associate UX Designer | Spring Computing Technologies *Dec 2020 – Jan 2022*

Pune, India. Healthcare SaaS product team building scheduling and prescription management tools for US clinics.

- **Designed data-driven interfaces** for healthcare scheduling and e-prescription management. Improved usability and HIPAA compliance readiness across multiple US client deployments.
- **Increased product adoption** through A/B testing, ongoing user feedback loops, and iterative prototyping with engineering and product.
- **Shipped high-fidelity, compliance-ready designs** on schedule across release cycles, and partnered with QA on design and accessibility checks.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Sonic Fire Extinguisher | Patent-Filed R&D, VIT Pune *Team Lead*

Led a team of 4 through 10+ design and prototype iterations to build a fire-suppression system that puts out flames using low-frequency sound waves, no chemicals or water. Designed the amplifier-circuit interface and the frequency-modulator companion app that lets users tune the suppression frequency in real time. Patent filed, and we co-authored the research paper documenting methodology, experimental setup, and results.

Script.io | Live Transcription for Students with Disabilities *Lead Designer | WCAG*

Led design on a live-transcription web app for students with hearing and learning disabilities, including international students sitting through lectures in a non-native language. Spent a lot of time embedded with disability services and the actual users to figure out what real-time content needs to look like for it to be usable. Ran user research and usability testing with international students and accessibility specialists, then

worked with engineering to ship a WCAG 2.1 AA-compliant experience that balanced real-time performance with readability.

Natural-Language Query Builder | Zams *GenAI / LLM*

Designed an LLM-powered interface that lets non-technical business users query datasets in plain English. The hard problem was hallucination trust, so we landed on an "explain-then-execute" pattern that surfaces the model's interpretation of the prompt before it actually runs the query. About 60% of new users adopted it in the first month after launch.

Clinician Decision-Support UI | Carolina's Psychiatric Institute *Healthcare AI*

Designed an AI-assisted prescription review interface that gives clinicians ML recommendations without taking control away from them. Used progressive disclosure and confidence indicators so providers stay in the driver's seat. Reduced average chart-review time meaningfully across pilot practices.

SKILLS & KEYWORDS

AI / GenAI Design: LLM Interfaces, Human–AI Interaction, GenAI Product Design, AI UX Patterns, RAG, Agents, Multimodal UX, ML Pipeline UX, Prompt Design, Conversational UI, Confidence & Hallucination Patterns, AI-Assisted Prototyping

Product Design: End-to-End UX, 0-to-1 Product Design, Design Systems, Component Libraries, Design Tokens, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, User Flows, Wireframes, High-Fidelity Prototyping, Visual Design, Typography, Layout Systems, Data Visualisation, Mobile Design, Responsive Web Design, Design QA

Research & Strategy: User Research, Qualitative Interviews, User Surveys, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Multivariate Testing, Journey Mapping, Personas, Heuristic Evaluation, Design Thinking, Stakeholder Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Agile / Scrum, Sprint-Based Design

Industries: AI / GenAI SaaS, B2B SaaS, Enterprise SaaS, Healthcare SaaS, HealthTech, Fintech, FinTech UX, E-commerce, Analytics & BI, Developer Tools, No-Code, Donation / Non-Profit

Compliance & Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, ADA, HIPAA, Accessibility-First Design, Inclusive Design, Assistive Technology

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Framer, ProtoPie, Sketch, Adobe XD, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects, Miro, Jira, Confluence, Notion, Slack, Google Analytics

Methods: Lean UX, Human-Centred Design, Iterative Prototyping, Rapid Prototyping with AI Tools, Behavioural Analytics, Data-Informed Design

RECOGNITION & PUBLICATIONS

- **Patent (Filed):** Sonic Fire Extinguisher: Method & Apparatus for Fire Suppression Using Low-Frequency Sound Waves. Co-inventor with a team of 4 at VIT Pune.
- **Research Paper:** Sonic Fire Extinguisher: An Environment-Friendly Approach to Fire Suppression Using Low-Frequency Sound Waves. Co-authored documentation of methodology, experimental setup, and results.
- **Master's GPA:** 4.0 / 4.0 at The University of Texas at Austin, MS in Information Studies (UX Design specialisation).